Interim CEO roadmap: the written plan

Version: v1 · **Date:** 17 October 2026 · **Author:** Judith Mueller, candidate for Interim CEO

A mock-up by a candidate for the Interim CEO role. Not a Verity document.

Initial research so far: built only from the application pack and public information, and to be updated. It goes with the roadmap dashboard.

> *Verity's pack asks for an agreed roadmap within the first six weeks. This is how I would start building it, using only the pack and public information. It is a scaffold. It shows how I think and how the work would look: a dashboard the Board can follow, with every figure marked as real, estimated or still to be found. Once I know Verity from the inside, much of it will change, and all of it would be worked out in far more detail. I have written it to be useful whoever takes the role.*
>
> Judith Mueller

1. What this is, and how it would develop

Sent further to my application, as a scaffold that may be useful whoever is appointed. No reply needed. Verity starts from a position few charities reach, built by volunteers.

A scaffold, not the full roadmap. Verity's pack asks for "an agreed roadmap in place within the first six weeks". I would get there in four steps:

Before 4 January	End of week 2	Weeks 3 to 5	Week 6
Optional introduction calls and pre-start questions, as goodwill	The first full roadmap, fleshed out from this scaffold	Tested with every trustee	Agreed by the Board, then tracked month by month

The contract clock would start on Monday 4 January 2027.

2. What needs to get done

The pack sets two jobs "above all others": **an income base that can fund a permanent part-time CEO**, and **the systems and structures for Verity to become an employer for the first time**. Every step in the roadmap is tested against the pack's six end-of-contract tests:

Accountability	By the end of the contract (Verity's words)
1. Financial sustainability and income generation	An income strategy agreed by the Board with targets, owners and timescales; a live grants pipeline with a stated value; and a clear picture of the funding secured towards the permanent post and the gap remaining.
2. Building the infrastructure to become an employer	An employer-readiness plan signed off by the Board, providers appointed, and systems documented and in use.
3. Strategic and operational leadership	An agreed roadmap in place within the first six weeks, and trustees spending materially less time on operational delivery than at the start.
4. Governance and organisational leadership	An agreed scheme of delegation, a consistent Board reporting pack, and clear role descriptions across the team.
5. Impact, external profile, risk and compliance	Key relationships mapped and held organisationally, agreed impact measures with baseline data, and a live risk register reviewed at every Board meeting.
6. Transition and handover	A defined and costed permanent CEO role with a recruitment plan, and a written handover pack completed before the contract ends.

I would take on as much external work as the Board wants, at its pace, alongside the trustees who lead it.

3. What six months can deliver, and what it cannot

Six months at two days a week can deliver properly

- The roadmap agreed by the Board, with people, systems and money mapped
- The Board report, scheme of delegation and risk register in use
- The income strategy agreed, the pipeline live and the first applications in
- The employer-readiness plan signed off, providers chosen and policies drafted
- The permanent CEO role defined and costed, with a recruitment plan
- A handover pack

What it cannot, because of lead times rather than effort

- **The funding for a permanent CEO.** Trust decisions take 16 weeks to 6 months, so applications sent in months 2 to 4 are decided in months 6 to 10.
- **A permanent CEO in post.** A CEO search typically takes around six months, plus one to three months' notice, and it needs the funding to be reasonably clear first.
- **Employer systems fully in use.** They are only truly in use once someone is employed.
- **Trustee-dependent work at full speed.** Board reports need trustees' input, sign-offs wait for Board meetings, and relationship records need every trustee.

Six months at two days a week is enough to build the foundations properly. Securing the funding for a permanent CEO, and appointing one, depends on funders' decision times and a recruitment process, and realistically concludes around month twelve. The roadmap is therefore modelled on six months, with an optional second half at one day a week, **to be discussed and agreed**. The table shows what each option would mean in total.

Option	Interim CEO days	Months 7 to 12	A permanent CEO could start
A. Six months as in the pack: two days a week after a two-week ramp-up	56	Trustees lead, with the handover pack	Spring 2028 at the earliest
B. Twelve months at two days a week	about 105	As C, with more capacity for recruitment and income	January 2028
C. Six months as A, then six months at one day a week the roadmap is modelled on this, to be discussed and agreed	about 80	Run the systems, steward funding decisions, recruit, hand over	January to March 2028

The pack offers a six-month contract "with view to extend up to 12 months" (page 12). Day totals are after bank holidays.

4. Before the start

As goodwill on my side, and only if it suits you, I would be happy to start getting to know everyone before the contract begins, so that day one starts with what is needed:

1. **Contract signed:** A contract for services. The contract clock starts on 4 January; everything before it is goodwill on my side.
2. **Introductions:** One-hour calls at times that suit you, with each trustee (including the 2026 trustees) and the administrator.
3. **Notes back:** Written notes from each call within two days, for each person to add to.
4. **Pre-start questions, optional:** About you; a two-week time log; a list of systems and who holds each account (no passwords); documents shared once the contract is signed.
5. **Day one:** A short catch-up with everyone: anything else for my first two weeks.

Pre-start questions (optional)

- **About you:** Your skills, what you do for Verity today, what you would like to do, the time you have for the transition and long term, and your networks.
- **A two-week time log:** What you actually do for Verity, and how long it takes. It gives the baseline for the test in accountability 3.
- **Systems list:** What Verity has, what you would like, what is missing, and who holds each account. No passwords.
- **Documents, once the contract is signed:** Policies, the grant strategy, current figures and grant agreements, key relationships and who holds them, and the media set-up.

Dates before a January start, in case useful

- Rosa, Voices from the Frontline: closes 4pm, 16 November
- The Fore: registration 25 November to midday, 4 December
- Hospital Saturday Fund: 2 December and 5 January
- Early conversation with The Waterloo Foundation

5. How the work is organised

Workstreams are grouped by the two jobs, plus running and protecting Verity. ● marks what the pack asks for; ◆ marks what I think is also needed.

Workstream	Origin	Accountability
Before the start		
◆ Introductions and pre-start questions	Added	A3
◆ Funding deadlines before January	Added	A1
◆ Set-up and compliance	Added	A4
Job 1: an income base for a permanent CEO		
● Income strategy and pipeline	In the pack	A1
● Income streams, including PMOS TIME	In the pack	A1
● Staffing model: people and systems	In the pack	A2, A1
● Business case and funding gap	In the pack	A1
Job 2: ready to employ		
● Employer readiness	In the pack	A2
● Systems mapping and build	In the pack	A2
● Governance and the Board report	In the pack	A4
Running and protecting Verity		
● Roadmap and leadership	In the pack	A3
◆ People, skills and resources	Added	A3, A4
● Impact, relationships and risk	In the pack	A5
● External representation	In the pack	A5
◆ Media and communications capability	Added	A5
● Permanent CEO and handover	In the pack	A6

6. What I would ask for first

Before the start, in the pre-start questions

- The NICE publication on 27 January: your plans and any embargo arrangements
- The grant strategy
- Current funders, their grant end dates and terms
- The latest figures and management accounts
- Who the trustees who joined in 2026 are, their skills and the roles they would like
- The administrator's hours and arrangement
- Existing policies, a list of systems (no passwords), insurance and registrations
- The 2027 Board dates
- A two-week time log, if possible
- How the APPG will be funded from April 2027
- The media set-up: budget, processes, who prepares
- Key relationships, and who holds them

In the first weeks

- How the interim role is funded
- The pace of the media and stakeholder handover, and which relationships trustees keep
- The Board's position on industry funding
- The days, salary and timing the Board has in mind for the permanent post

7. The main risks, and how the plan handles them

Risk	How the plan handles it
The main funder does not renew, or renews on narrower terms	Protect the existing funder first: an early conversation before January, then regular contact. Build several income streams so that no single funder dominates.
Two days a week against two large jobs	Priorities agreed with the Board in week 6. The dashboard shows each month's days, so trade-offs are visible and decided, not discovered.
Most income is restricted to specific purposes, and a permanent chief executive needs core or multi-year funding	Unrestricted and multi-year funding first, and a fair share of core costs in every project bid.
Safeguarding in the online support groups, with over 12,000 members	A review in the first months, with clear moderation and reporting routes, before Verity becomes an employer.
Relationships and knowledge held by individuals	A relationship map recorded in a supporter database, and processes written down, so that knowledge belongs to Verity.

8. Beyond the interim: 2028 to 2030

For the Board to shape. A three-year horizon fits multi-year core grants (one to three years), the renaming's managed three-year transition, and a first strategy cycle for a permanent CEO. Beyond that, the direction is the mission itself, reviewed every year. What a permanent team would need in place:

- **Income:** Several income streams so that no single funder dominates; multi-year core grants; regular giving; earned income including PMOS TIME; a reserves policy; the APPG funded separately.
- **People:** The permanent CEO in post; a staffing map shaped by the people-and-systems decision; clear volunteer roles; media work that does not rest on one person.
- **Governance:** Scheme of delegation, Board report and risk register embedded; a Board skills and renewal plan; an annual review.

- **Systems:** Supporter database; finance, HR and media processes; the dashboard with login and comments; plus additional systems, to be mapped.
- **Mission:** NICE implementation; the renaming's managed three-year transition, with the new name integrated into the 2028 international guideline update; the APPG's recommendations; the research priorities; reach into underdiagnosed communities.

9. What the dashboard does now, and what I would add

A snapshot built from public information. It shows what Verity has to deliver and by when, who does what, how many days each step takes, and how long it waits on others, with every figure marked as real, extrapolated or still a gap. Each month the same page would show progress against the plan agreed in week 6.

- **Secure login:** Password-protected access.
- **Comments in one place:** Trustees, the team and invited partners can comment on any item, so all input sits together.
- **One source of truth:** Updated each month from one spreadsheet, so the Board pack is produced, not written.
- **Views for different people:** The Board sees everything, the team their own actions, invited partners only what they are shown.
- **Owners update their own work:** Each owner updates the status of their own steps.
- **A history:** Each month's version is kept, so progress and decisions can be traced.
- **Reminders and export:** Deadline reminders from the calendar, and a PDF for the Board papers.
- **Safe by design:** No personal or health data on the dashboard, and access logged.

Appendix: a guide to the dashboard

Real figure Extrapolation, to be updated Gap, to be filled

Verity today	Key figures, each coloured by how solid it is: a real figure, an extrapolation to be updated, or a gap to be filled. Each shows its source.
What needs to get done	The two jobs the pack says everything else serves.
The six tests	The six accountabilities, each with Verity's own words for what must be true by the end of the contract. Progress starts at zero.
The roadmap	One row per step, grouped by job and workstream. Each step shows who is involved and how many Interim CEO days it takes. Solid bars are working time, outlined bars are work by trustees or the administrator, hatched bars are waiting time, and numbered diamonds are Board decisions the work depends on.
● and ◆	● marks workstreams the pack asks for. ◆ marks suggested additions. A1 to A6 are the pack's six accountabilities.
Interim CEO days	Planned days against the days available each month. Before the start is goodwill and not counted.
Months 7 to 12	Optional: what I would aim to deliver if time and funding allow, to be discussed and agreed.
Before the start	Optional introduction calls, notes back and pre-start questions, so that day one starts with what is needed.
Team and resources	One row per role, filled in from the pre-start questions: skills, time now and long term, and networks.
What I would add	The functions a live version would have, starting with a secure login and comments in one place.

Sources

- **Verity Interim CEO application pack and advert**: September 2026
- **Verity's filed accounts to 31 March 2025**: Charity Commission, charity 1097599
- **Charity Commission and Companies House registers**: read 16 October 2026
- **NICE project page GID-NG10436**: expected publication 27 January 2027, read 17 October 2026
- **Register of All-Party Parliamentary Groups**: 1 September 2026 edition
- **Funders' own websites**: The Fore, Rosa, Hospital Saturday Fund, Garfield Weston, National Lottery Awards for All, Big Give, read 6 to 16 October 2026
- **The Waterloo Foundation annual report 2025**: page 16
- **GOV.UK employer guidance**: PAYE, workplace pensions, employers' liability insurance, right to work; read 16 October 2026
- **Verity's website and social media pages**: read 16 and 17 October 2026

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